initially in charge of economic decision making following the coup. Aung Gyi's faction wanted industrialization and a slow approach to nationalization. The private sector would be permitted to continue in industry and the import-export sector would be allowed to continue. Foreign investment would be encouraged, while the import substitution industrialization program, which started during the caretaker period, continued. The emphasis early on would be small industry.

Tin Pe, a former minister of mines, labor, public works, and national housing, led the main opposition faction in the post-1962 period. Pe emerged as the minister of cooperatives and agriculture and forests following the Revolutionary Council's takeover. Tin Pe called for a more radical Marxist approach to economic policy. The cooperative held the key to the “Burmese Way to Socialism” and the government needed to aggressively implement cooperative efforts. The radical faction pushed for greater emphasis on crop rotation, paddy transplantation, and the use of high-quality seeds.

Both the USSR and United States were helpful in these agricultural endeavors. The Soviets would be instrumental in the construction of dams for irrigation. The Burmese government would be required to hire Soviet engineers and contract only through the USSR for the upkeep and needed machinery. The United States through the United States Agency for International Development (USAID) loaned the Burmese government 3.4 million dollars to assist in land reclamation in the Ayeyarwaddy and Pegu regions. The staunch neutrality of the Burmese government (even dating back to the U Nu period) probably helped to facilitate these agreements with the Cold War rivals.

The plan for Burma's economic future was laid out with the issuing of the “System of Correlation of Man and His Environment” in early 1963. This document was a strange ideological mix of Buddhism, Marxism, and historical dialecticism. According to the document, the exploitation of man by man should be discouraged. Man should be responsible for the spiritual growth of society and class antagonisms should be abolished. Society was always in flux so the leaders in Burma needed to be willing and able to alter the plans accordingly.